

HOLLOW PORTALS: Urdu Akademi; vice-chairman Aqeel (right)



movement to promote and preserve local culture. Though it gets an annual grant of Rs 17.10 lakh, it suffers from a lack of identity. Professor of history, culture and archaeology at the Ram Manohar Lohia Avadh University, Faizabad, Ajay Pratap Singh says the

institution has been unable to conduct proper research, which could have been possible only if it was attached to the Avadh University.

Yet another institution is the Uttar Pradesh Bhasha Sansthan. Its main task is to translate technical textbooks

on engineering and medicine into Hindi but this has never been attempted. The government has also revamped another organisation—the UP Hindi Sansthan by doing away with the practice of the Assembly Speaker heading it and engaging a prominent writer to take control. The government was so engrossed in making these changes that it completely forgot about holding its important annual event—the Hindi writer's award. Aspirants for the prestigious awards will now have to wait till next September. No such wait for the bureaucrats and politicians heading these organisations for whom life goes on with perks and all. ■



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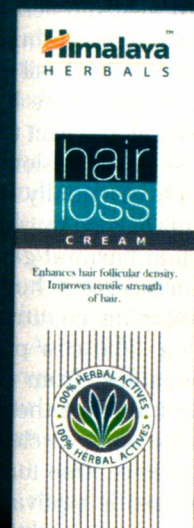
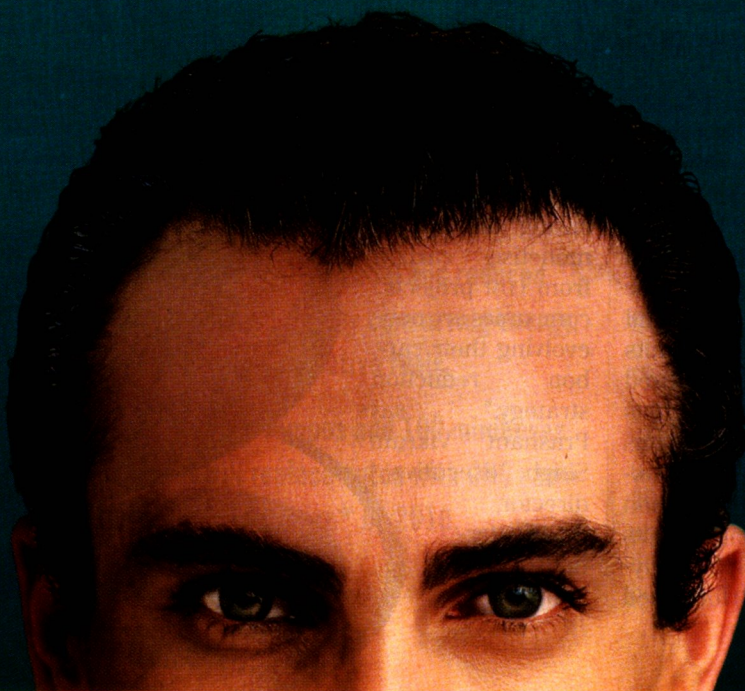


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